

August

15



1947 The partition of India

When granting independence to the Indian subcontinent, the British partitioned (divided) the region into two countries based on religion – Muslim-majority Pakistan and Hindu-majority India. Millions were forced to leave their homes and move to the newly formed countries, with many travelling in jam-packed trains.

Born this day

1964 Melinda French Gates, US humanitarian. As a co-founder of the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, she has worked to improve gender equality and health care.

Small carnivore 2013

Scientists at the Smithsonian in the USA announced the discovery of a meat-eating mammal called the olinguito. This relative of the raccoon uses its large eyes and sharp claws to hunt prey in the forests of Colombia and Ecuador.



Also on this day

1914 The Panama Canal, a 77 km (48 mile) waterway, opened to ships. The canal connected the Pacific and Atlantic oceans by cutting across Panama. Previously, ships had to sail all the way around South America.

1948 The first elected government of South Korea was formed, led by President Syngman Rhee, ending a period of US military rule.



1969 Woodstock Festival

More than 400,000 music fans gathered in a farm in Bethel, New York, USA, to watch rock 'n' roll stars such as Jimi Hendrix (above), The Who, the Grateful Dead, and Janis Joplin. This festival is remembered as one of the greatest moments in music history.